

THE LAND INTELLIGENCE SERIES

20 REASONS TO OWN LAND IN DODD CITY TEXAS

THE INVESTOR'S GUIDE TO FANNIN COUNTY'S
NEXT LAKE-AND-HIGHWAY GROWTH CORRIDOR



LANDZILLE
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20 Reasons to Own Land in Dodd City, Texas

The Investor's Guide to Fannin County's Next Lake-and-Highway Growth Corridor

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INTRODUCTION

THE WINDOW IS OPEN



Every great land story in Texas begins the same way. A quiet town sits on a highway. Something big arrives nearby — a lake, an employer, a new road — and for a few years, only a handful of people notice. Then the rest of the market catches on, and the land that once changed hands quietly becomes the land everyone wishes they had bought.



Dodd City is at the beginning of that story right now.

This small Fannin County community sits on U.S. 82, a short drive east of Bonham, at the meeting point of four forces that rarely line up in one place: a brand-new regional reservoir at Bois d'Arc Lake, a second major reservoir filling at Lake Ralph Hall, a manufacturing and housing surge in Bonham, and steady population growth across Fannin County. Each one on its own would be worth watching. Together, they make Dodd City one of the most compelling early-stage land markets in North Texas.

The investment case for Dodd City is not about what the town is today. It is about where it sits — and what is being built all around it. This book gives you twenty clear, evidence-backed reasons to own land in Dodd City. It shows you the strategies that fit different investors, the simple checks that separate a great parcel from an ordinary one, and exactly how to take your next step. Read it with a pen in hand. By the last page, you will know whether Dodd City belongs in your portfolio — and we believe it does.

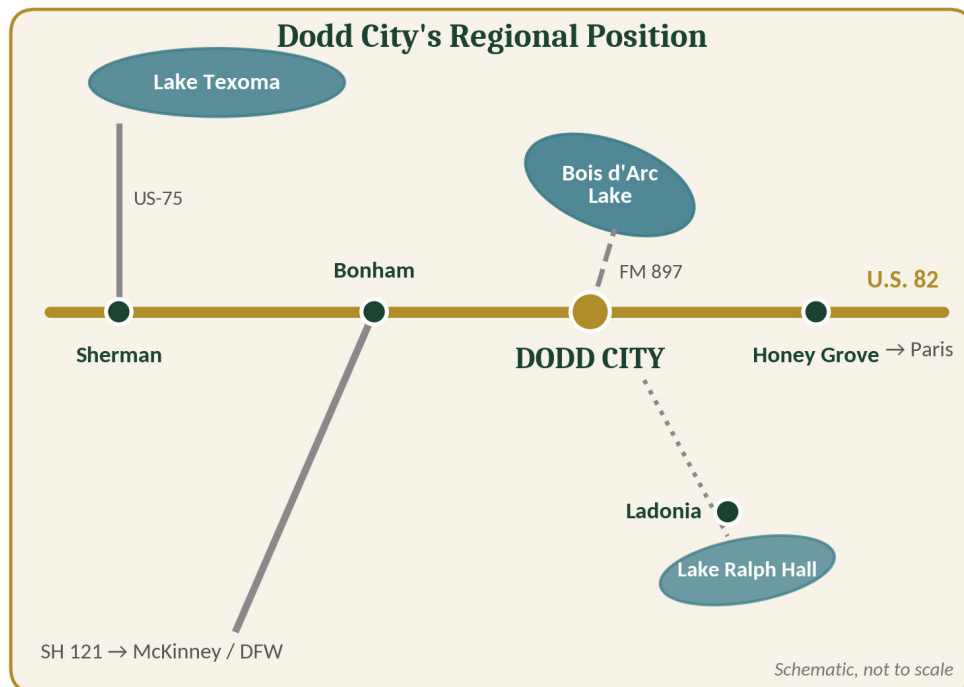
CHAPTER ONE

DODD CITY AT A GLANCE

Before we get to the twenty reasons, here is the big picture: where Dodd City sits, what surrounds it, and what land is selling for today.



Dodd City's power lies in its position. To the west is Bonham, the county seat and the engine of new jobs and housing. To the north is Bois d'Arc Lake, reached by FM 897. To the southeast is Lake Ralph Hall and the Ladonia corridor. And running straight through town is U.S. 82 — the east-west artery linking Sherman, Bonham, Honey Grove and Paris.



KEY FACTS

Location	U.S. 82 corridor, eastern Fannin County, a short drive east of Bonham
County population	39,265 (2025 estimate), up 9.6% since 2020
Primary lake catalyst	Bois d'Arc Lake — up to 82 million gallons per day of regional water supply
Second lake catalyst	Lake Ralph Hall near Ladonia — began filling July 2026
Nearest job center	Bonham — county seat, U.S. 82 / SH 121 crossroads
Distance to DFW	Bonham is about 60 miles from the Metroplex
City utilities	Municipal water and sewer service
Schools	Dodd City ISD, a local PK–12 district
Average land price	About \$31,700 per acre (asking-price average)

WHAT LAND COSTS TODAY



AVERAGE DODD CITY LAND PRICE ≈ \$31,700 per acre

Average asking price across representative area listings, September 2026. Not an appraisal.

Across the representative Dodd City–area land listings we reviewed in September 2026 — spanning large farms, small lake-lifestyle tracts and U.S. 82 highway parcels — the **average asking price was approximately \$31,700 per acre.**

That single number tells an important story. Dodd City land remains priced as rural and exurban land, even though it now sits beside a major new reservoir and a growing manufacturing hub. Buyers are paying for today's rural reality while positioning for tomorrow's regional growth. That gap between today's price and tomorrow's potential is where land wealth is built. (Individual parcels vary with frontage, utilities and lake access — see the checklist in Chapter Seven.)

CHAPTER TWO

THE LAKE ADVANTAGE

Two new reservoirs and a network of parks and lakes give Dodd City something most small Texas towns will never have: a permanent reason for people to come — and to stay.



REASON 1: BOIS D'ARC LAKE CREATES LASTING REGIONAL DEMAND

Bois d'Arc Lake is the single strongest catalyst in the Dodd City story. Built by the North Texas Municipal Water District, it supplies up to 82 million gallons of water per day to a system serving more than 2.3 million residents and businesses.

It is also a destination. Texas Parks and Wildlife rates its largemouth bass, catfish and crappie fishing as excellent, and the lake supports boating, fishing, picnicking and outdoor recreation. That means repeat visitors, weekend traffic and new demand for places to stay, eat, store boats and build homes.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Land with easy access to FM 897 and the boat ramps is positioned for cabins, short-term lodging, RV concepts, lake-support retail and future residential lots.

REASON 2: THE LAKE IS CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE — NOT A FAD

Many lake-town booms fade because they depend on vacation demand alone. Bois d'Arc is different. It is a core water-supply asset for one of the fastest-growing regions in America. In late September 2026, state reservoir data showed it at roughly 90% storage.

Water is the foundation of all growth in Texas. Communities near reliable new supply are the communities that can grow.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Your land sits next to permanent public infrastructure, giving the Dodd City growth story a far sturdier foundation than a market built on lakefront speculation.

REASON 3: A WHOLE NETWORK OF LAKES AND PARKS SURROUNDS YOU

Dodd City is not relying on one attraction. The region's outdoor assets include Lake Bonham, Bois d'Arc Lake, Bonham State Park and Lake Ralph Hall. Bonham State Park alone offers fishing, paddling, swimming, camping, hiking and biking.

This density of recreation is what draws retirees, second-home buyers, remote workers and outdoor families — the buyers who drive rural land demand.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Multiple lifestyle anchors mean broader, more durable buyer demand for your land, whether you hold, build or resell.

REASON 4: LAKE RALPH HALL IS THE NEXT WAVE

Just to the southeast near Ladonia, Lake Ralph Hall began construction in 2021 and started filling in July 2026. When complete, it will provide up to 54 million gallons of water per day, with recreation opening once filling and safety preparations are finished.

Investors who watched Bois d'Arc Lake transform its surroundings now have a second chance — and Dodd City sits between both lakes.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Owning in Dodd City gives you exposure to two lake-driven land cycles at once: Bois d'Arc today and Lake Ralph Hall in the years ahead.



CHAPTER THREE

JOBS, PEOPLE AND MOMENTUM

Land values follow jobs and people. Next door in Bonham, both are arriving.



REASON 5: DODD CITY SITS BESIDE BONHAM'S GROWING ECONOMY

Bonham is Fannin County's principal employment and service center, located at the crossroads of U.S. 82 and SH 121. Its economic development corporation, BEDCO, is investing a \$1.1 million 2025–26 budget in infrastructure, airport improvements, parks and strategic commercial and industrial growth.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Dodd City can capture the housing, storage, service-business and land demand Bonham generates — at rural pricing rather than county-seat corridor pricing.

REASON 6: VECTOR SYSTEMS CHOSE BONHAM

In 2026, Vector Systems — a global manufacturer of industrial process equipment — relocated its headquarters from McKinney to Bonham. BEDCO reports the move brought roughly 100 additional jobs, with plans to expand to about 56,000 square feet and substantially grow the business over the next three years.

When a company leaves one of the hottest suburbs in America for Fannin County, it sends a signal every land investor should hear.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: New manufacturing jobs create demand for workforce housing, contractor yards, supplier sites and service businesses east of Bonham — right where Dodd City sits.

REASON 7: A MANUFACTURING CLUSTER IS FORMING

Vector Systems is not alone. BEDCO reports expansion activity from Renlita Creative Openings, Tongrun International and Trans Cable as well. Tongrun received a city tax abatement, and Trans Cable entered a development agreement.

One relocation is news. Four expanding manufacturers is a trend.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: A diversified employer base spreads risk and broadens long-term demand for land that serves workers and industry.

REASON 8: BONHAM'S HOUSING PIPELINE IS PUSHING OUTWARD

National homebuilder D.R. Horton is bringing Asher Oaks, a 78-lot single-family community, to Bonham. Powder Creek Ranch is planned as a large master-planned community blending residential, commercial and recreational uses.

When national builders commit to a market, surrounding land tends to follow. As Bonham fills in, growth looks for the next affordable, well-connected place — and U.S. 82 leads straight to Dodd City.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Dodd City acreage is positioned as the natural follow-on market as Bonham adds households and jobs.

REASON 9: FANNIN COUNTY IS GROWING

The U.S. Census Bureau estimates Fannin County reached 39,265 residents in 2025, up 9.6% from 2020. Owner occupancy stands at 78.7% — a community of people who put down roots.

For a predominantly rural county, that is meaningful, steady growth.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Rising population strengthens the long-term hold case for well-located residential and mixed-use land.

REASON 10: THE WORKFORCE IS DEEPENING

Federal labor data show roughly 9,121 jobs across 651 Fannin County employers in early 2026. Census data show an 87.7% high-school completion rate and 84.9% household broadband subscription.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: A connected, capable local workforce supports continued manufacturing and service growth — and the land demand that comes with it. Broad broadband adoption also supports remote and hybrid workers choosing rural acreage.

CHAPTER FOUR

ACCESS AND INFRASTRUCTURE

Growth needs roads, water, power and services.
Dodd City already has more of them than most rural towns its size.



REASON 11: U.S. 82 FRONTAGE CREATES COMMERCIAL OPPORTUNITY

U.S. 82 runs directly through Dodd City, and highway-frontage tracts in the area are actively marketed for commercial, RV and development uses. Frontage land is finite — once it is owned and built, it is gone.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Highway frontage is positioned for logistics support, flex industrial, RV and hospitality, convenience retail and long-term commercial land banking.

REASON 12: FLEXIBLE LAND IS AVAILABLE BEFORE THE CITY ARRIVES

Some U.S. 82 parcels outside Dodd City's limits have been marketed as unzoned — the kind of flexibility that disappears as markets mature and rules tighten. Early investors can still secure land whose future uses are open.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Buying before full urbanization gives you the widest range of future options — and the opportunity to capture the value that entitlement creates.

REASON 13: DODD CITY HAS MUNICIPAL WATER AND SEWER

Many rural Texas towns rely entirely on wells and septic systems. Dodd City provides both water and sewer service, and adopted an updated rate schedule in August 2026.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: In-town parcels with documented city utilities can support greater residential density and commercial use — a meaningful edge over purely rural acreage.

REASON 14: UTILITIES ALREADY REACH RURAL ACREAGE

Utility access is not limited to the town center. Area listings report Dodd City water serving larger rural tracts, co-op electricity along portions of U.S. 82, and rural-water studies completed on highway parcels.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Land that already has water and power nearby is ready to work for you sooner. Ask for written will-serve letters and confirm meter capacity before you buy.

REASON 15: SERVICES NEARBY, COUNTRY LIVING AT HOME

Bonham, just west, provides the everyday retail, groceries, pharmacy and services that families need. Dodd City residents enjoy space, privacy and rural character without the isolation of far-flung Texas land.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: That balance is exactly what today's rural land buyers want — and it makes your land easier to use, build on and eventually sell.

REASON 16: LOCAL SCHOOLS ANCHOR FAMILIES

Dodd City has its own independent school district serving pre-kindergarten through twelfth grade. That local anchor means Dodd City is not only a weekend or second-home market — it is a place families can live full-time.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: A local school district supports demand for conventional family homes and residential lots. Check boundaries and performance data for any residential plan.



CHAPTER FIVE

VALUE AND TIMING

The best land deals are made before the crowd arrives.
In Dodd City, the timing is still in the investor's favor.



REASON 17: LARGE TRACTS OFFER AN ATTRACTIVE ENTRY POINT

Larger agricultural tracts around Dodd City — with pasture, farmland and stock tanks — are typically offered well below the area's overall average price per acre. These tracts can produce agricultural use and income while you wait for growth to arrive.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Buy at a rural basis, keep the land productive, and preserve every future option: ranching, subdivision, lake-lifestyle lots or legacy holding.

REASON 18: SMALLER LAKE TRACTS CREATE FASTER RETURNS

Smaller tracts near the FM 897 boat ramp at Bois d'Arc Lake carry noticeably higher per-acre prices than large farm tracts — clear evidence that buyers already value lake access. These parcels can be turned into lake homes, retreats and recreational lodging far faster than large land banks.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Smaller lake-access tracts suit investors who want quicker use, rental income or resale, while large tracts suit long-term wealth builders.

REASON 19: ECONOMIC-DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMS ADD UPSIDE

Bonham's Type B economic development corporation is funded by a half-cent sales tax, and the city and county created TIRZ #3, a 30-year reinvestment zone targeting downtown and the Highway 56, 78, 82 and 121 corridors.

These are Bonham programs and do not automatically apply to a Dodd City parcel. But they show a region actively investing in growth — and incentives for the right project can be negotiated.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Treat incentives as a bonus you pursue and document, not as part of your base-case value. When they land, your returns improve.

REASON 20: GET IN BEFORE IT BECOMES A SUBURB

Bonham is about 60 miles from the Dallas–Fort Worth Metroplex and roughly 30 minutes east of Sherman. Dodd City lies just beyond — an outer-ring market that offers more land and more options per dollar while staying connected to U.S. 82, SH 121 and North Texas growth.

That is the sweet spot. Investors who buy while a town is still rural capture the value created as growth moves outward. Those who wait until it is a suburb pay suburban prices.



INVESTOR ADVANTAGE: Dodd City rewards patient capital: land that works today as rural and exurban property, positioned to benefit as North Texas growth continues to move outward.



CHAPTER SIX

FIVE WAYS TO WIN IN DODD CITY

Pick the strategy that matches your goals, timeline and budget.



1. THE HIGHWAY PLAY

BEST RISK-ADJUSTED OPPORTUNITY

Acquire U.S. 82 frontage or utility-served acreage for commercial, flex-industrial, RV, hospitality or service uses. Highway visibility plus Bonham's manufacturing growth creates the clearest commercial case in the market.

2. THE LAKE LIFESTYLE PLAY

BEST GROWTH OPPORTUNITY

Target smaller tracts near FM 897 and Bois d'Arc Lake for lake homes, cabins, retreats and short-term lodging. Buyers are already paying a premium for lake access — and the lake's permanence supports that demand.

3. THE LEGACY LAND BANK

BEST LONG-TERM HOLD

Buy larger agricultural acreage with water and good road frontage at a rural basis. Keep it productive with farming or grazing while the region grows around it, then subdivide, develop or pass it on.

4. THE WORKFORCE PLAY

RIDING BONHAM'S JOB GROWTH

Position land for workforce housing, contractor yards, storage and supplier sites that serve the manufacturers expanding in Bonham.

5. THE TWO-LAKE PLAY

DIVERSIFIED LAKE EXPOSURE

Hold land that benefits from both Bois d'Arc Lake today and Lake Ralph Hall as it fills and opens to recreation in the years ahead.



THE PRINCIPLE: Whatever your strategy, the principle is the same: buy land that makes sense under today's conditions, and let the region's growth deliver the upside.

CHAPTER SEVEN: BUY SMART: THE DODD CITY CHECKLIST

Great land investors do not just buy in the right town. They buy the right parcel. Use this checklist on every Dodd City tract you consider — it takes days, and it protects years of returns.

ACCESS

- ☐ Confirm legal road access and frontage on U.S. 82, FM 897 or a maintained county road.
- ☐ For highway frontage, check TxDOT driveway permit requirements.

UTILITIES

- ☐ Request written will-serve letters for water, and confirm meter and line capacity.
- ☐ Confirm electric provider, three-phase availability and any extension costs.
- ☐ Verify internet or fiber options if you plan to live or work on the land.

USE RIGHTS

- ☐ Confirm zoning or permitted uses with the City of Dodd City, including its extraterritorial jurisdiction (ETJ) rules.
- ☐ Check Fannin County subdivision rules and any Bois d'Arc Lake or Lake Ralph Hall zoning or overlay requirements.
- ☐ Review deed restrictions and easements, including any transmission lines.

LAND QUALITY

- ☐ Check FEMA and Fannin County floodplain maps, and confirm with a survey.
- ☐ Test soils for septic suitability if city sewer is not available.
- ☐ Walk the land for drainage, creeks, wetlands and usable acreage.

DEAL STRUCTURE

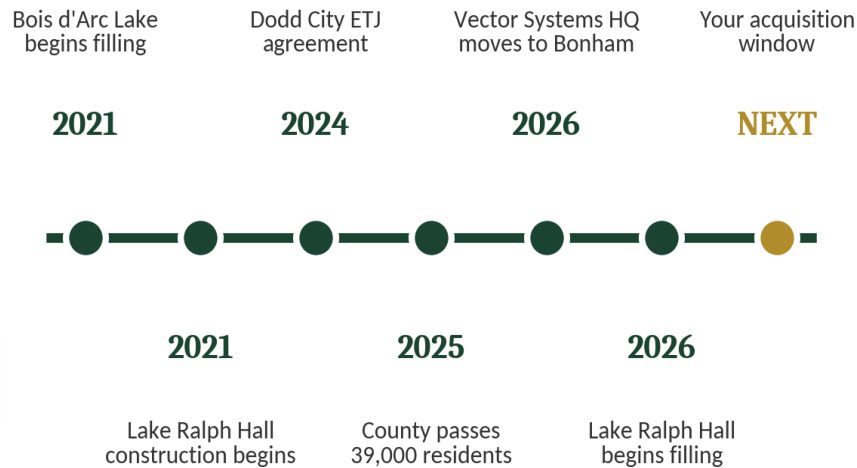
- ☐ Compare the asking price to the area average and to similar tracts.
- ☐ Ask about seller financing and agricultural tax status.
- ☐ Match the parcel to one of the five strategies before you sign.



BOTTOM LINE: Land that passes this checklist is land you can buy with confidence. The more boxes a parcel checks, the stronger your position.



CHAPTER EIGHT: WHY NOW



Look at the timeline. In just five years, Dodd City's surroundings have changed more than in decades. Bois d'Arc Lake is operating. Lake Ralph Hall is filling. Bonham has landed a headquarters relocation and a wave of manufacturing expansion. National homebuilders are building. The county is growing.



Yet Dodd City land is still priced as rural land.

That gap will not last forever. Every new job in Bonham, every boat launched at Bois d'Arc, every family that moves to Fannin County narrows it a little more. The investors who act while the gap is wide are the ones who capture the value when it closes.



The next milestone on this timeline is yours to write.

CHAPTER NINE

YOUR NEXT MOVE

You have read the twenty reasons. You know the strategies and the checklist.
Here is how to turn knowledge into ownership.



STEP 1: CHOOSE YOUR STRATEGY.

Highway, lake lifestyle, legacy land bank, workforce or two-lake. Your goal decides your parcel.

STEP 2: SET YOUR BUDGET AND FINANCING.

Decide how much you will invest and whether seller financing, cash or a partner structure fits best.

STEP 3: SEE THE LAND.

Drive U.S. 82, FM 897 and the lake. Nothing replaces standing on the ground you plan to own.

STEP 4: RUN THE CHECKLIST.

Verify access, utilities, use rights and land quality before you commit.

STEP 5: MAKE YOUR OFFER.

Good land in a growing corridor does not wait. When a parcel checks your boxes, move.

WORK WITH LANDZILLE

Landzille LLC is a North Texas land investment company focused on Fannin County and its neighbors. We help investors find, evaluate and acquire land positioned for growth — including seller-financed opportunities that make ownership more accessible.

If Dodd City belongs in your future, let's talk. Reach out today for current available tracts, a parcel walkthrough, or a conversation about your land investment goals.

Landzille LLC

Anna, Texas

The best time to buy land in Dodd City was five years ago. The next best time is now.

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ABOUT LANDZILLE

Landzille LLC is a North Texas land investment company based in Anna, Texas, serving investors across Collin, Cooke, Fannin, Hunt and Lamar counties. Landzille combines on-the-ground market knowledge with disciplined analysis to help investors acquire land with built-in equity and long-term growth potential.

Through the Land Intelligence Series, Landzille publishes practical, research-driven guides to the North Texas communities where the next chapter of growth is being written.



This book is a Landzille | Skillweed Academy Publication
Built for entrepreneurs who are serious about building right.